

DISCIPLINARY POLICY

Version 3.0 · Effective 1 April 2026

ARTICLE 1 - PROGRESSIVE STEPS

- 1.1 Verbal warning:** documented in the HRMS and valid for 6 months.
- 1.2 Written warning:** valid for 12 months.
- 1.3 Show-cause notice:** the employee responds in writing within 7 days.
- 1.4 Final warning / suspension:** suspension pending inquiry is paid at 50% (India) or at local statutory rates.
- 1.5 Termination.**

ARTICLE 2 - GROSS MISCONDUCT (STEPS MAY BE SKIPPED)

- 2.1** Fraud or falsified claims
- 2.2** Theft
- 2.3** Harassment
- 2.4** Violence
- 2.5** Data breach through wilful negligence
- 2.6** Working under the influence
- 2.7** Undisclosed conflicts of interest
- 2.8** Unauthorised absence for 8+ consecutive days
- 2.9** Leaking confidential information

ARTICLE 3 - FAIR PROCESS

- 3.1** The employee is informed of the allegation in writing and may respond and be accompanied by a colleague.
- 3.2** An inquiry officer independent of the reporting line runs the inquiry.
- 3.3** The decision is issued within 30 days.
- 3.4** Appeal to the Head of People within 7 days of the decision.

ARTICLE 4 - PERFORMANCE VS CONDUCT

- 4.1** Poor performance is handled first through a PIP (see the Performance Management Policy). Misconduct is handled under this policy.

ARTICLE 5 - PURPOSE AND SCOPE

- 5.1** Makes sure misconduct is handled consistently, fairly and lawfully. Applies to all employees after they join, including during probation (with a shortened process).

ARTICLE 6 - INVESTIGATION STEPS

- 6.1** The complaint or observation is logged by HR.
- 6.2** Preliminary assessment within 3 days: is an inquiry needed?
- 6.3** An inquiry officer is appointed, and the charge sheet is issued in writing.
- 6.4** The employee responds (7 days), and witnesses are interviewed.

6.5 The inquiry report is submitted to the disciplinary authority.

6.6 A decision letter is issued, stating the right of appeal.

ARTICLE 7 - PROPORTIONALITY EXAMPLES

7.1 Conduct: Repeatedly late to client calls; Typical first action: Verbal warning

7.2 Conduct: Timesheet inaccuracies (first time); Typical first action: Written warning

7.3 Conduct: Sharing credentials with a colleague; Typical first action: Written warning + security training

7.4 Conduct: Inflated expense claim; Typical first action: Show-cause → termination

7.5 Conduct: Harassment proven by the IC; Typical first action: Per IC recommendation, up to termination

ARTICLE 8 - RECORDS

8.1 Warnings are placed on the personnel file and expire after their validity period, except in cases of gross misconduct.

ARTICLE 9 - REVISION HISTORY

9.1 3.0 (2025): Inquiry timelines added.